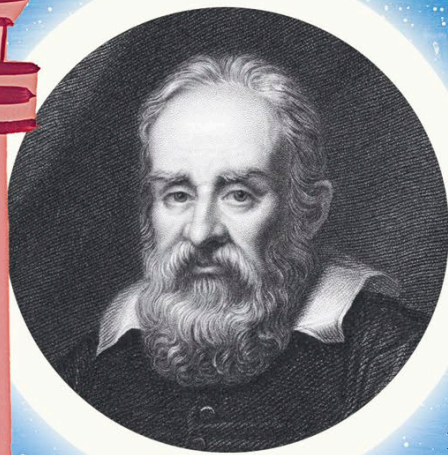


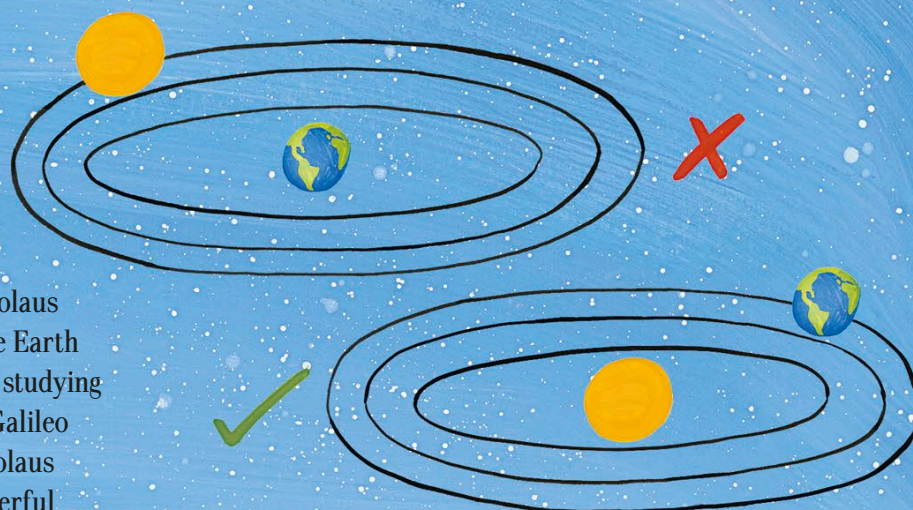


In the 1500s and 1600s, many beliefs about how the world worked were based on old ideas from ancient Greece. They included concepts that seem very strange to us now—such as the belief that the Earth was at the center of the universe—orbited by the sun, planets, and stars!

Galileo Galilei was a very creative person. He was not afraid to question these old ideas and come up with new ones. To do this, Galileo observed things carefully, building his own instruments, such as telescopes, to get a better look. He designed experiments to test ideas and find out what was really happening. The things he discovered may seem obvious to us now, but many people at the time disagreed with him.

Center of the solar system

A Polish astronomer named Nicolaus Copernicus had the idea that the Earth was traveling around the sun. By studying the night sky with a telescope, Galileo found evidence that proved Nicolaus was right. This upset many powerful people, and Galileo was ordered to stay at home and stop spreading the truth. But nothing could stop him from working.



Before Galileo, most people wrongly believed that the sun orbited the Earth, not the other way around.

Galileo didn't invent telescopes, but he improved them by making his own lenses—the curved pieces of glass inside that make objects look bigger.



GALILEO GALILEI

Italian mathematician and astronomer
1564–1642